FedCast

A forecaster for the next Federal Reserve rate decision, built to be judged by its process rather than its luck

Tan Kah Ming · Fullerton · October 2026

About me



Tan Kah Ming

Senior AI, Data and Technology Consultant, seconded to Temasek Holdings, Digital Innovation (2023 to now)

Before that

- Data scientist, RSAF Data Office: authored the Air Force's AI strategy, set up its first digital unit
- Air engineering and weapons logistics officer, where the data-driven habit started (Weibull analysis, predictive maintenance)

Training

M.Eng Aeronautical Engineering, Imperial College London · Graduate Certificate in Predictive Analytics, NUS · CFA Level 3 candidate (February 2027)

Things I have built that models had to earn trust in

1

Investment analytics at Temasek

An AI-assisted analyst performance and attribution platform for 50+ investment professionals, with an LLM signal tracker for high-conviction ideas; signal cadence moved from monthly to daily, every recommendation logged in real time.

2

Valuation and execution

A machine-learning mark-to-market for private holdings, systematic and reproducible; and an AI-driven order management system on AWS processing about S$30m a day, replacing an email-based workflow.

3

Forecasting under a scoreboard

4th of 160+ teams (MIT, DoD, USAF) in the 2023 USAF AI Accelerator, predicting pilot flying difficulty from physiology; an ammunition recommender (quantile LightGBM) that cut wastage with no shortfall, Defence Manpower Committee Innovation Award 2022.

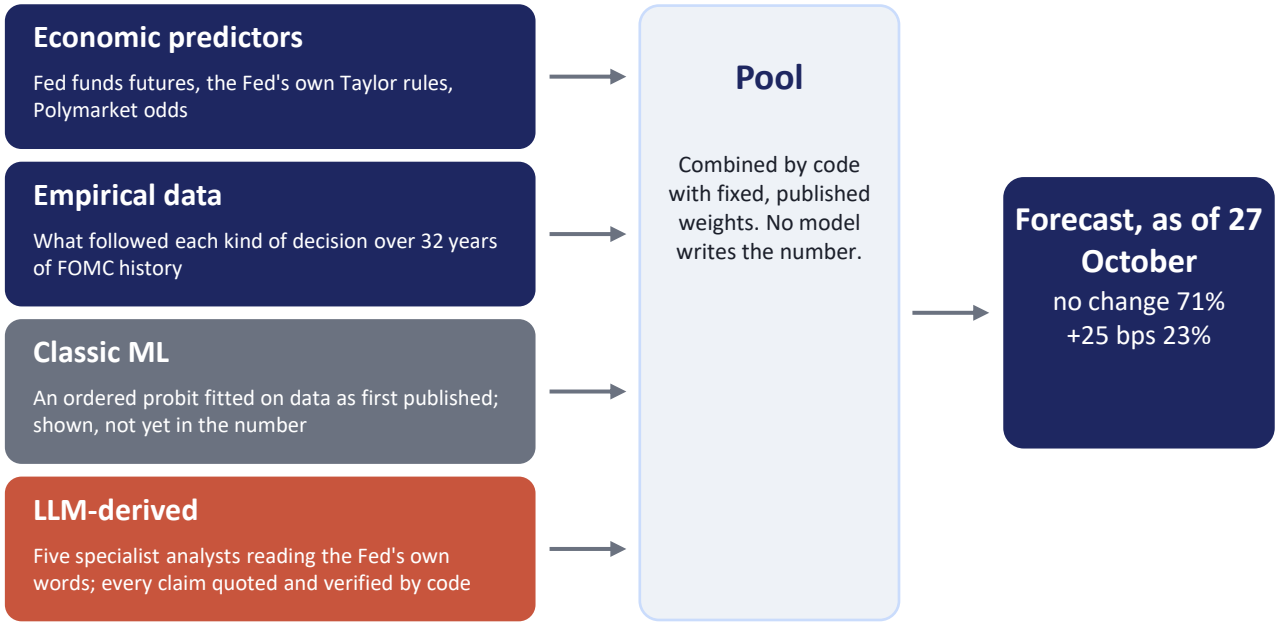
4

COVID-19, 2021

Built, in weeks, the system that engaged every home-recovery patient in Singapore, 10,000 people a day, on form.sg, Azure and Zendesk. The lesson that carries over: a system people rely on must say what it knows and what it does not.

What FedCast is, and why we built it

A forecast of the next FOMC decision as probabilities over five outcomes, from one frozen snapshot of evidence.
As of 27 October, for 28 October 2026: no change 71%, +25 bps 23%.



What it does

- Freezes one fingerprinted snapshot of evidence per forecast; nothing outside it may be read.
- Enforces repeatability: five identical runs per analyst, tools off, every quote/output checked by code, a pre-registered scorecard on every snapshot.
- Offers typed channels for human judgement (views, watch-outs, documents, odds): bounded, recorded, scored afterwards. None active today.
- Keeps every snapshot and forecast in a hash-chained ledger, so the number's path can be read back as information arrived.

Why we built it

1 Fed prediction tools are judged on outcomes, which cannot be repeated

Many Fed tools exist. With only eight decisions a year, a hit rate cannot separate luck from skill, and next year is a different draw. **We believe a robust process requires repeatability.**
So we judge ours on a pre-registered process: does the same evidence give the same answer, can every claim be traced, does a shock move the number the right way.

2 Most lean too far one way

Either empirical formulas and market prices alone, or everything thrown at a language model. Ours combines the three: **empirical data**, **classic ML** and a **harnessed LLM**, each with a stated role and a stated weight, combined by code.

3 What this model offers

Auditability: every input visible, every forecast replayable.
Evidence-based: every claim quoted and verified, nothing from memory. A harnessed LLM cannot give random or spurious answers; a naive LLM is kept as the control, so what the harness adds is measured, not assumed. Anyone can see how one piece of evidence moves the decision.
Backtest-able: the model can be scrutinised and improved, instead of hoping the LLM works.